

Gabo Esquivel

Senior Product Engineer, AI

I build production AI products: voice and chat assistants, retrieval, and the admin tools a team needs to run them after launch. 15+ years across TypeScript, React Native, Next.js, and cloud. Fluent in English, Spanish, Portuguese, and Italian.

Highlights

- 12+ years building 0→1 products for startups and growth-stage teams
- Tuned a production AI legal assistant for attorney tone, gender, and persona, improving speed and optimizing tool calling in React Native
- Built the bitlauncher.ai RAG chatbot and Masterbots chat prompting on production launchpad products
- Led engineering for Wink, Costa Rica's first neobank, from architecture to launch

Skills

- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL
- **AI / ML:** LLMs, OpenAI, AI SDK, RAG, Realtime Voice
- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, React Native, Expo, Tailwind, shadcn/ui, TanStack
- **Backend:** Node.js, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Redis, GraphQL
- **Cloud & Infra:** AWS, GCP, Vercel, Docker, Serverless

Experience

Software Engineer, LegalAgent

Remote • Contract • 2025

AI legal platform with voice, chat, and retrieval for case context, documents, and procedures.

- Shipped a voice and chat assistant in React Native (Expo).
- Built RAG for case context and document summaries.
- Built the TanStack Start admin with Microsoft SSO, document management, and retrieval categories.
- Shipped bilingual voice with realtime transcription and speech synthesis.
- Worked with the firm's attorneys on how they used the assistant, then tuned persona and tool calling from that feedback.

Product Engineer, Bitlauncher

Remote • Full-time • Nov 2023 – Nov 2025

AI and crypto launchpad with retrieval, research tools, and specialized assistant work.

- Owned product direction, roadmap priorities, and delivery planning while remaining hands-on in architecture.
- Built the bitlauncher.ai chatbot with RAG and tools for current news and video.
- Implemented Masterbots prompting and AI-assisted internationalization.

Software Engineer, Opyn

Remote • Contract • Oct 2024 – Feb 2025

Options protocol on Arbitrum with a trading interface and indexed onchain data.

- Prototyped an LLM assistant for onboarding and support.
- Built the Next.js 14 trading interface with React Server Components.
- Indexed onchain data with Ponder, PostgreSQL, and Supabase.

Lead Engineer, Bitcash

Remote • Part-time • Jan 2020 – Jul 2021

Fiat-to-stablecoin and crypto exchange with peer-to-peer trading, chat, and browser signing.

- Built the React, Vite, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Hasura, and Google Cloud stack.
- Built the peer-to-peer exchange, realtime chat, and matching engine.
- Built WebAuthn key management for in-browser transaction signing without an external wallet.

Lead Engineer, Wink

On-site • Full-time • Apr 2015 – Mar 2018

Costa Rica's first neobank: React Native app, AWS backend, partner-bank APIs, and biometrics (holawink.com).

- Built the React Native app and AWS backend.
- Integrated partner-bank APIs so deposits, transfers, and account data moved through the app.
- Built biometric KYC with a React Native native bridge.
- Coordinated with partner-bank teams and vendors on the first version.

Additional experience

Between those roles I led engineering at EOS Costa Rica (2018–2020) through the EOS mainnet launch and a private-chain MVP for Grant Thornton Labs, and worked on Emanate's streaming platform (2019–2020). From 2021 to 2023 I built an NFT indexer and marketplace at RareMint (2021–2022) and a WebGL wallet connector for ZTX (2022–2023). Earlier I led frontend for AMC Networks' YEAH! (2012–2014) and built card marketing products at American Express (2010–2012).

Connect

Open to direct hire, international hire, or contracting through Blockmatic Labs LLC. Based in Costa Rica and working US Mountain Time.

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The rest of the work is on gaboesquivel.com.